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unit 2 - Interactions Among Hardware Parts

PDF Documents

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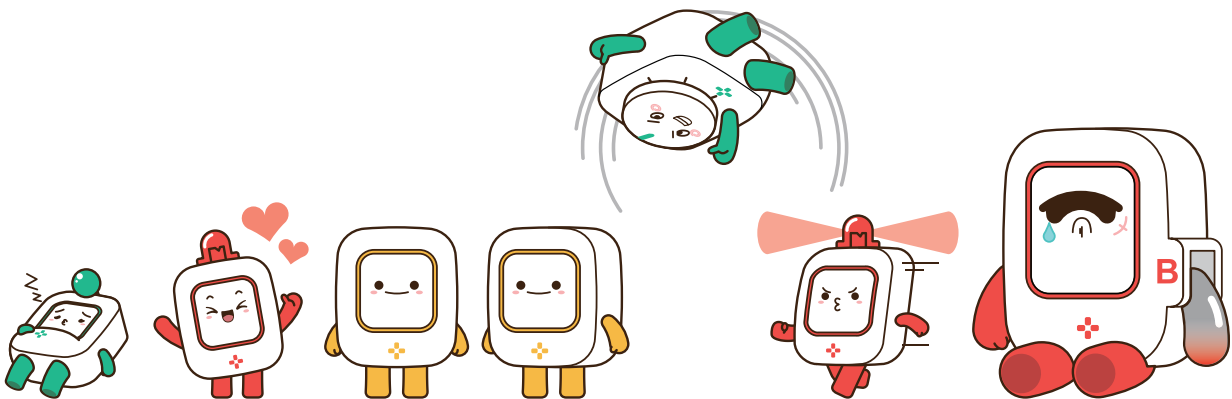
UNIT 2 INTERACTIONS AMONG HARDWARE PARTS

Welcome back, young explorers! In Unit 1, we discovered the amazing parts that make up computers and robots. Now, let's dive deeper and see how these parts talk to each other. Just like in a team where everyone has a role, in computers and robots, each part has a special job. But for the team to win, they need to work together perfectly. Let's explore how!



The Beginning of a Journey: Gathering Clues

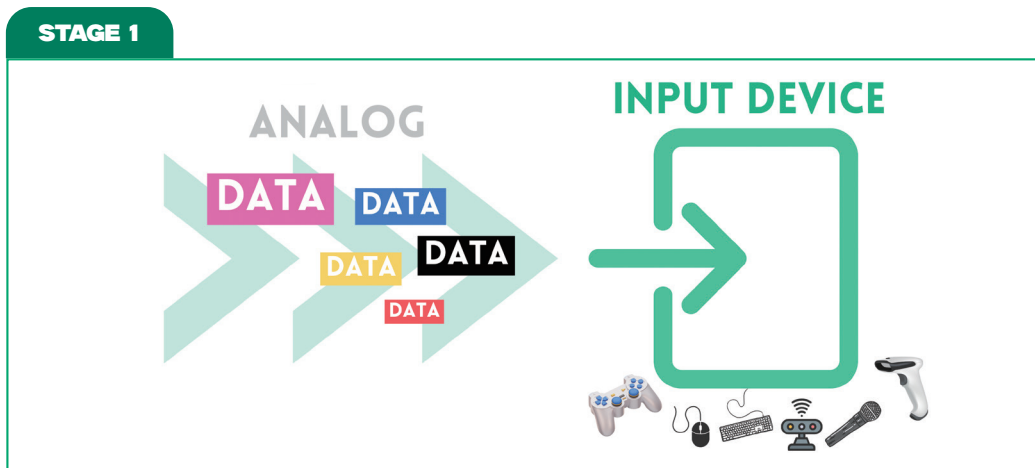
Think of data as information or instructions that need to be communicated within the system. This journey is crucial for the device to perform tasks, whether it's solving a math problem, displaying a video, or guiding a robot's movement.



Now, let's explore how external data travels through the computing system and emerges through output devices. Check out the detailed steps on the following pages!

STAGE 1: GATHERING DATA - THE ROLE OF INPUT DEVICES

The journey begins when data is collected through input devices. Input devices can vary from keyboards and mice for computers to sensors and cameras for robots. These devices capture information from the external environment, which could be anything from a keystroke or mouse click to temperature readings or visual cues.

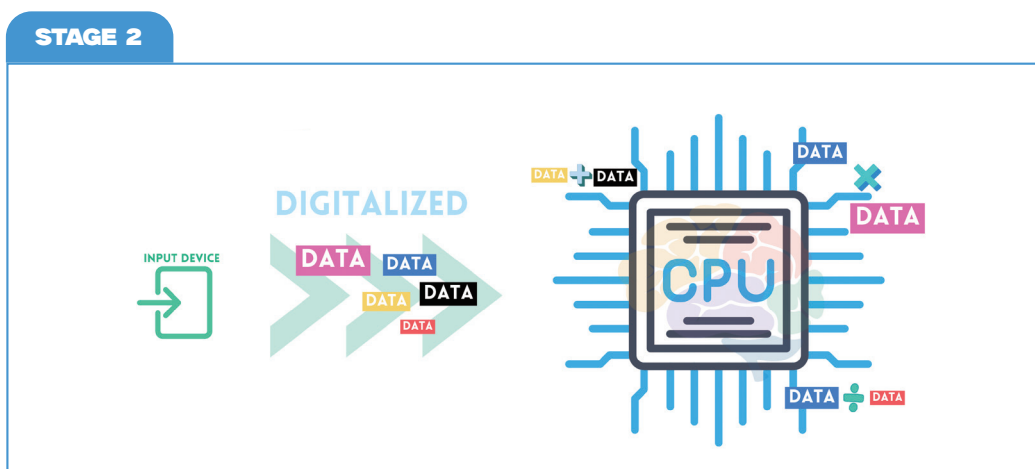


Keyboards and Mice: When you type or click, you're sending specific instructions to the computer. Each keystroke or click is a piece of data that the computer needs to interpret and act upon.

Sensors in Robots: Sensors allow robots to receive data about their surroundings. For example, a light sensor might detect the level of brightness in a room, providing essential data for the robot's next action.

STAGE 2: PROCESSING DATA - THE CENTRAL PROCESSING UNIT (CPU)

Once data is collected, it's sent to the CPU, the computer's or robot's brain. The CPU's job is to interpret this data, perform necessary calculations, and make decisions based on programmed instructions. This stage is critical because the CPU determines what the data means and what should be done with it.

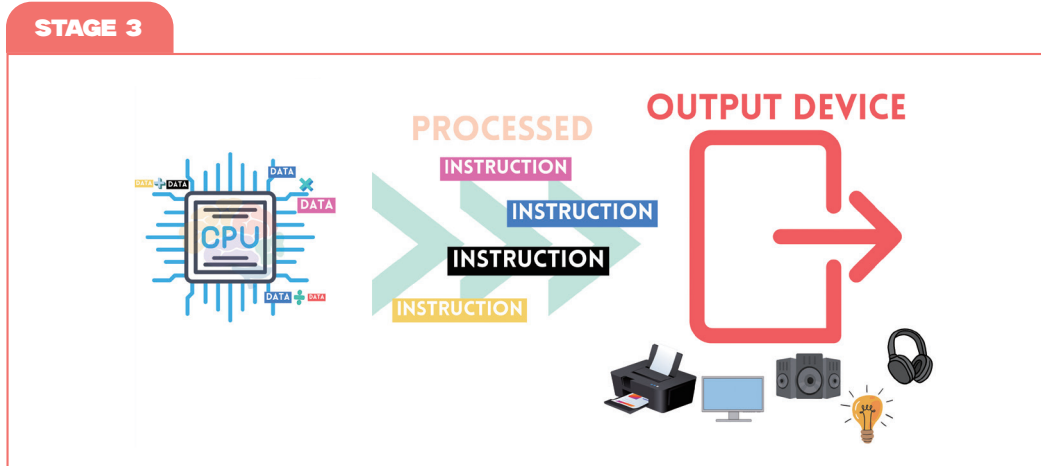


Decision Making: The CPU uses the data to decide the next steps. For example, if you're playing a game and press the jump button, the CPU processes this input and updates the game accordingly.



STAGE 3: COMMUNICATING RESULTS - OUTPUT DEVICES

After the CPU processes the data, the results need to be communicated, which is where output devices come into play. These devices include monitors, speakers, and printers for computers, and motors or lights for robots. They take the processed data and convert it into a form that we can understand or respond to.

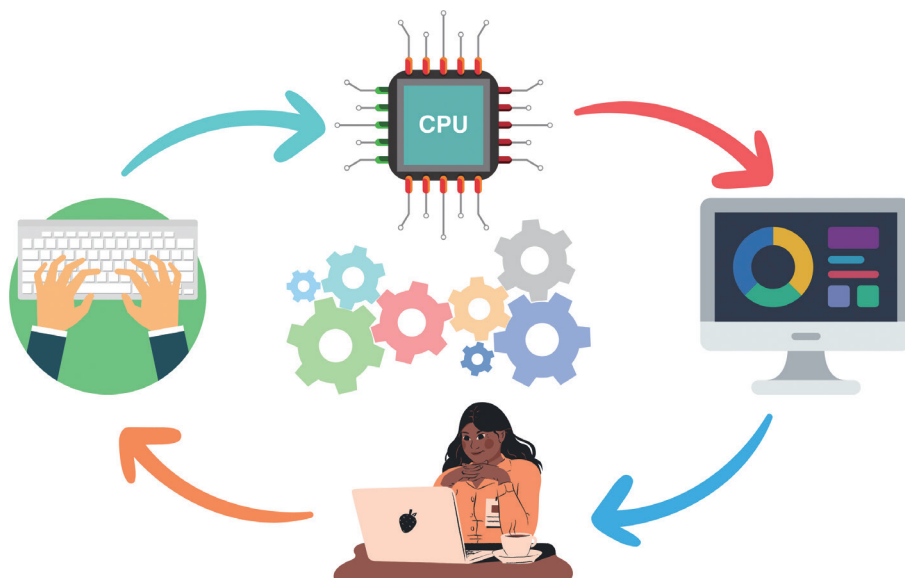


Monitors and Speakers: These devices display images and produce sounds, allowing us to see the results of processed data, such as a video or music.

Robot Motors: Actuators and motors act on the processed data by moving parts of the robot, enabling it to carry out tasks like moving or grabbing objects.

CONCLUSION:

Understanding the journey of data from the moment it's collected by input devices to when it's acted upon by output devices is fundamental to grasping how computers and robots function. This flow of data is what allows these devices to assist us in countless tasks, making them indispensable tools in our daily lives.



Discussion Questions

Discussion Question 1

Define input and output in your own words.

Discussion Question 2

What would happen if we did not have any input devices?